

Logistics Market Intelligence Report Ocean

Monthly Report | Sep 2026

SAMSUNG SDS





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1. Executive Summary

Demand

- 2026 global container trade is projected to grow 3.8% YoY. US-bound demand remains stronger than expected, while Europe-bound demand has slowed after the early peak season, widening route divergence.
- Q3 2026 Asia-North America trade remains stronger than expected as shipping demand persists amid tariff uncertainty.
- Q3 2026 Asia-Europe trade is projected to grow 1.3% YoY. Volumes have declined rapidly following the early peak season from May to July, with Q3 demand growth expected to slow sharply compared with a year earlier.

Supply

- 2026 global containership supply is projected to grow 4.6% YoY, outpacing demand. Structural oversupply persists, but China port disruptions, Red Sea diversions and Hormuz restrictions limit effective capacity.
- Newbuild deliveries are projected at 1.6m TEU in 2026, remaining high, while scrapping stays low. Large-scale deliveries from 2027 may increase medium- to long-term supply pressure.
- Capacity deployment on major routes is expected to increase broadly in September to meet China's pre-Golden Week shipping demand.

Freight Rates

- The SCFI Comprehensive Index rose 6.8% MoM in August as US strength offset N.Europe and Med weakness. Route divergence may persist in September, with US rate strength driving index direction.
- USWC and USEC rates rose 10.9% and 15.7% MoM in August. Delayed China port recovery and pre-Golden Week shipments may support both, with tighter Panama restrictions further supporting USEC.
- N.Europe and Med rates fell 11.3% and 14.2% MoM in August. Lower peak-season demand and moves by some carriers to return to Suez may sustain downward pressure in September.
- ECSA and Middle East rates rose 20.7% and 26.2% MoM in August, remaining strong. Limited ECSA capacity and Hormuz uncertainty may support rates in September.

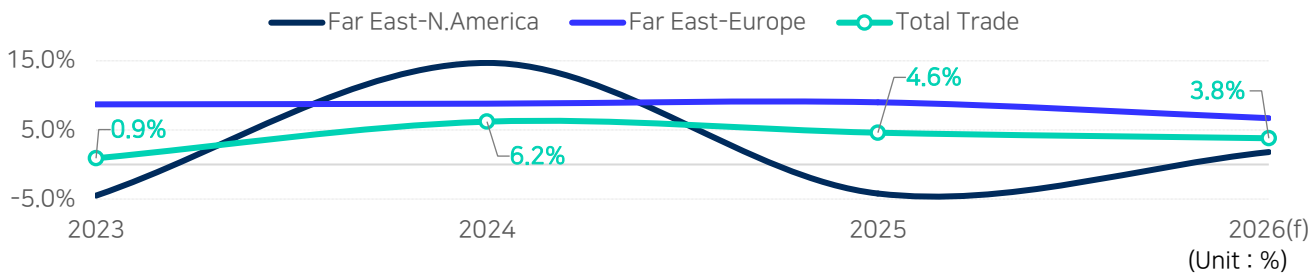


2. Container Market

Global Container Trade

- 2026 global container trade is projected to grow 3.8% YoY. US-bound demand remains stronger than expected, while Europe-bound demand has slowed after the early peak season, widening route divergence.
- Q3 2026 Asia-North America trade is projected to decline 1.7% YoY. Shipping demand has remained stronger for longer than expected amid tariff uncertainty, limiting the extent of the Q3 decline.
- Q3 2026 Asia-Europe trade is projected to grow 1.3% YoY. Volumes have declined rapidly following the early peak season from May to July, with Q3 demand growth expected to slow sharply YoY.

[Global Container Trade Growth Trend(YoY)]¹

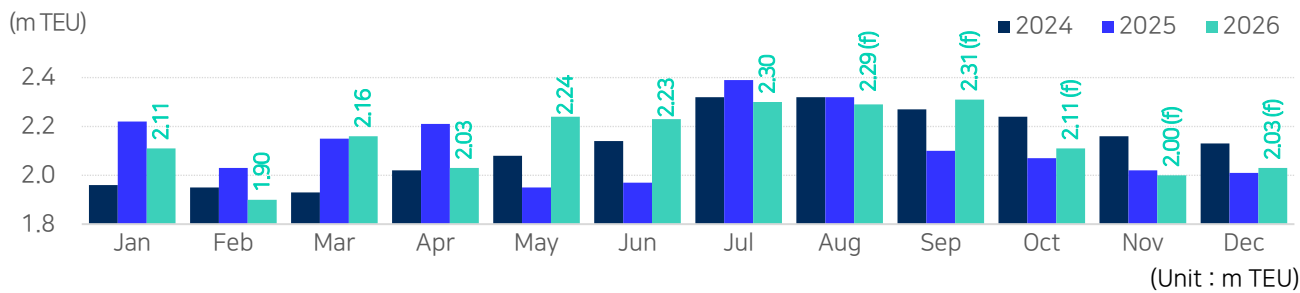


Trade Route	2023	2024		2025					2026(f)		
				Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4		Q1	Q2	Q3(f)
Global Trade	0.9%	6.2%	4.6%	-	-	-	-	3.8%	-	-	-
Far East-N.America	-4.5%	14.7%	-4.2%	7.1%	-8.6%	-7.6%	-6.0%	1.8%	-3.4%	10.8%	-1.7%
Far East-Europe	8.7%	8.8%	9.0%	9.1%	8.3%	12.2%	6.6%	6.7%	14.9%	10.5%	1.3%

Container Import Volume at Major US Ports

- August US imports are projected at 2.29m TEU, remaining near the annual peak after 2.30m in July. Resilient consumption and retailer imports are expected to keep volumes elevated.
- September imports are projected at 2.31m TEU, the highest level of the year. China weather disruptions and Panama diversions have delayed some arrivals, extending the peak season.
- Q4 imports are projected at 2.11m, 2.00m and 2.03m TEU for Oct-Dec, moderating through year-end after the September peak.

[Container Import Volume at Major US ports]²



Year	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Total
2024	1.96	1.95	1.93	2.02	2.08	2.14	2.32	2.32	2.27	2.24	2.16	2.13	25.52
2025	2.22	2.03	2.15	2.21	1.95	1.97	2.39	2.32	2.10	2.07	2.02	2.01	25.44
2026	2.11	1.90	2.16	2.03	2.24	2.23	2.30	2.29(f)	2.31(f)	2.11(f)	2.00(f)	2.03(f)	25.71(f)

¹ Clarksons

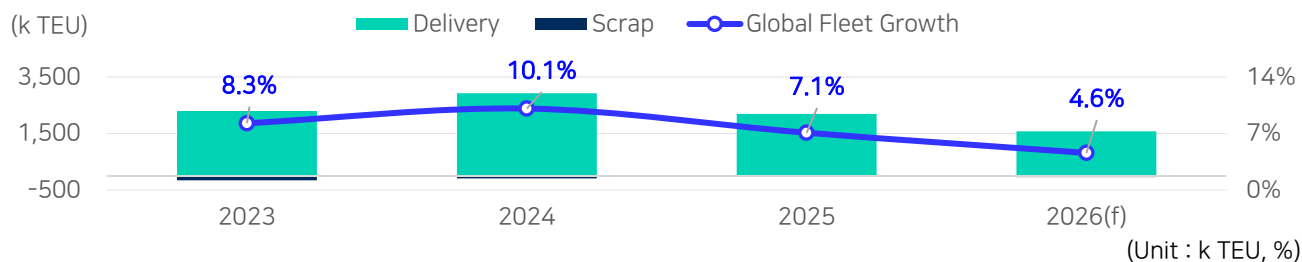
² NRF



Global Containership Fleet

- The global containership fleet is projected at 34.6m TEU in 2026, up 4.6% YoY. Structural oversupply persists, but China port disruptions, Red Sea diversions and Hormuz restrictions limit effective capacity.
- Newbuild deliveries are projected at 1.6m TEU in 2026, remaining high, while scrapping is expected to remain very low.
- Medium- to long-term supply pressure may increase from 2027 as newbuild deliveries expand.

[Global Containership Fleet Supply]³



Container Supply	2023		2024		2025		2026(f)	
		%YoY		%YoY		%YoY		%YoY
Global Fleet Growth	28,000	8.3%	30,900	10.1%	33,100	7.1%	34,600	4.6%
Delivery	2,298	124.8%	2,923	27.2%	2,192	-25.0%	1,579	-28.0%
Scrap	150	924.0%	83	-44.3%	5	-93.6%	41	661.0%

Regional Containership Deployment Shifts

- Asia-USWC deployment rose 5.5% MoM to 134 vessels in August and is projected at 138 in September (+3.0%), responding to resilient US demand and pre-Golden Week shipments.
- Asia-USEC deployment rose 12.5% MoM to 72 vessels in August and is projected at 75 in September (+4.2%). Panama slot cuts and draft limits may constrain effective capacity growth.
- Asia-N.Europe deployment fell 2.0% MoM to 97 vessels in August but is projected to rebound 12.4% to 109 in September. Higher deployment amid weaker demand may add downward rate pressure.
- Asia-Med deployment rose 4.9% MoM to 128 vessels in Aug and is projected to rise another 4.7% in Sep. Higher deployment and shorter routings from some carriers' return to Suez may add supply pressure.
- Asia-ECSA deployment fell 10.3% MoM to 35 vessels in August and is projected to rebound 11.4% to 39 in Sep. Deployment may rise on higher rates, but capacity recovery may remain limited after the August decline.
- Asia-Middle East deployment surged 32.1% MoM to 74 vessels in August and is projected to rise another 10.8% to 82 in September. Hormuz-related disruptions may limit effective capacity growth.

[Regional Containership Deployment Shifts]⁴

(Unit : Vessel, %)

Year	Month	Far East-USWC		Far East-USEC		Far East-N.Europe		Far East-Med		Far East-ECSA		Far East-ME	
			%MoM		%MoM		%MoM		%MoM		%MoM		%MoM
2026	Apr	116	-0.9%	63	6.8%	94	14.6%	124	12.7%	35	-2.8%	88	23.9%
	May	117	0.9%	63	0.0%	92	-2.1%	128	3.2%	33	-5.7%	81	-8.0%
	Jun	121	3.4%	70	11.1%	91	-1.1%	128	0.0%	35	6.1%	69	-14.8%
	Jul	127	5.0%	64	-8.6%	99	8.8%	122	-4.7%	39	11.4%	56	-18.8%
	Aug	134	5.5%	72	12.5%	97	-2.0%	128	4.9%	35	-10.3%	74	32.1%
	Sep(f)	138	3.0%	75	4.2%	109	12.4%	134	4.7%	39	11.4%	82	10.8%

³ Clarksons

⁴ Samsung SDS Brightics



Schedule Reliability & Port Congestion

- Global schedule reliability fell 6.1%p MoM to 56.4% in July. Typhoon-related disruptions at major Chinese ports significantly weakened reliability across major global routes.
- Asia-USWC schedule reliability fell 3.0%p MoM to 69.7% in July. US peak-season demand and operational disruptions at major Chinese ports combined to weaken reliability.
- Asia-USEC schedule reliability rose 1.7%p MoM to 71.5% in July. Longer transit times delayed the impact of China port disruptions versus USWC, resulting in a slight MoM gain.
- Asia-N.Europe schedule reliability fell 3.6%p MoM to 65.0% in July, indicating weaker schedule reliability.

[Schedule Reliability]⁵

(Unit : %, %p)

Route	26-May		26-Jun		26-Jul	
		%MoM		%MoM		%MoM
Global	64.5%	2.3%p	62.5%	-2.0%p	56.4%	-6.1%p
Far East-USWC	72.5%	0.1%p	72.7%	0.2%p	69.7%	-3.0%p
Far East-USEC	67.0%	4.4%p	69.8%	2.9%p	71.5%	1.7%p
Far East-N.Europe	68.0%	10.7%p	68.6%	0.7%p	65.0%	-3.6%p

- Long Beach congestion rose for three straight weeks from 19.4 vessels in W33 to 26.8 in W36. Stronger-than-expected US imports and concentrated vessel arrivals increased congestion.
- New York congestion edged up from 13.1 vessels in W35 to 13.9 in W36, but continues to fluctuate without a further material increase in congestion.
- Rotterdam and Hamburg congestion rose WoW to 57.8 and 37.0 vessels in W36. Despite lower cargo pressure versus H1, recent port disruptions including strikes drove a short-term rebound at Rotterdam.
- Shanghai congestion rose 8.1% from 196.2 vessels in W35 to 212.1 in W36. Repeated typhoon disruptions before existing backlogs cleared recently pushed congestion higher again.
- Singapore congestion rose 7.3% from 130.4 vessels in W35 to 139.9 in W36. China port disruptions increased regional schedule changes and transshipment pressure, adding to congestion.

[Port Congestion]⁶

(Unit : Vessels)

Region	Ports	2026							
		W29	W30	W31	W32	W33	W34	W35	W36
N.America	Long Beach	26.9	23.4	19.1	25.3	19.4	24.0	25.0	26.8
	New York	13.6	12.3	12.6	12.3	14.2	12.9	13.1	13.9
Europe	Rotterdam	63.5	62.3	58.5	55.3	55.8	59.3	45.2	57.8
	Hamburg	41.2	40.7	36.9	40.1	38.5	37.1	36.1	37.0
Asia	Shanghai	180.0	219.6	217.7	154.1	180.6	237.3	196.2	212.1
	Singapore	135.7	123.5	127.6	123.4	131.2	131.9	130.4	139.9

※ Outer Port In~Berth Out Average Count

⁵ Sea-Intelligence

⁶ Samsung SDS Cello Tracking



3. Ocean Freight Index Trends & Outlook

SCFI Trends

- The SCFI Comprehensive Index averaged 3,388pt in August, up 6.8% MoM, and rose for a sixth week to 3,590pt (+2.3% WoW) in W36. US strength offset N.Europe and Med weakness.
- USWC rates averaged \$6,726/FEU in August, up 10.9% MoM, with gains widening to \$7,242 (+4.4% WoW) in W36. Resilient US demand and China port disruptions supported strong rates.
- USEC rates averaged \$9,651/FEU in August, up 15.7% MoM, and rose further to \$10,324 (+2.8% WoW) in W36. China-origin schedule disruptions and Panama restriction concerns supported high rates.
- N.Europe and Med rates fell 11.3% and 14.2% MoM in August and another 2.7% and 3.2% in W36, respectively. Weaker demand after the early peak season sustained the downtrend.
- ECSA and Middle East rates rose 20.7% and 26.2% MoM in August. ECSA gained another 3.3% in W36, while Middle East fell 0.1%, indicating a pause in its recent uptrend.

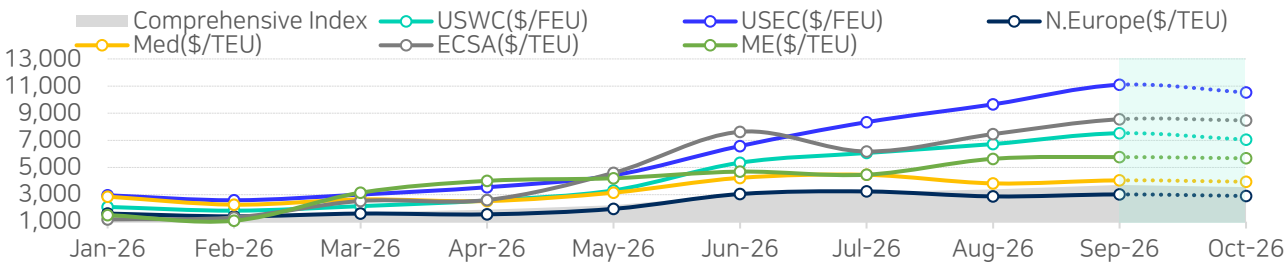
[SCFI Trends]⁷

Route	2026						Aug(Avg.)		
	W32	W33	W34	W35	W36	%WoW		%MoM	%YoY
Comprehensive Index	3,276	3,355	3,410	3,510	3,590	2.3%	3,388	6.8%	130.1%
USWC(\$/FEU)	6,484	6,714	6,765	6,940	7,242	4.4%	6,726	10.9%	266.7%
USEC(\$/FEU)	9,290	9,568	9,700	10,046	10,324	2.8%	9,651	15.7%	241.9%
N.Europe(\$/TEU)	2,964	2,945	2,842	2,716	2,643	-2.7%	2,866	-11.3%	59.6%
Med(\$/TEU)	4,048	3,929	3,767	3,557	3,442	-3.2%	3,825	-14.2%	69.3%
ECSA(\$/TEU)	6,238	7,119	7,805	8,663	8,953	3.3%	7,456	20.7%	107.7%
ME(\$/TEU)	5,258	5,422	5,729	6,139	6,135	-0.1%	5,637	26.2%	313.0%

Samsung SDS Short-term Forecast

- The SCFI Comprehensive Index may see continued US strength and N.Europe/Med weakness in September. With European rates remaining weak, index direction will largely depend on US rate strength.
- USWC rates are expected to remain supported in September as delayed China port normalization coincides with concentrated shipments ahead of Golden Week.
- USEC rates may remain high in September as China port disruptions and pre-Golden Week shipments coincide with tighter Panama transit slots.
- N.Europe and Med rates are expected to remain under pressure as peak-season demand declines. Shorter sailing distances and higher effective capacity from some carriers returning to Suez may add further pressure.
- ECSA and Middle East rates are expected to remain high amid continued supply constraints. Limited ECSA capacity and Hormuz transit uncertainty remain key supporting factors.

[Samsung SDS SCFI Forecast]⁸



⁷ Shanghai Shipping Exchange

⁸ Samsung SDS Brightics

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U.S. Tariff Policy: A Quick Overview

Registration date | AUG 20, 2026

[Tariff Summary by Country](#)

Category ▾	date	Details of Tariff Policies
Trade Enforcement Tariffs	2026.08.18	3-Day Suspension of Additional Duties Under Section 338 of the Tariff Act in Response to Canada's Discriminatory Trade Measures - 3-day suspension of additional duties in consideration of Canada's expressed commitment to remove the discriminatory measures and ongoing bilateral negotiations

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